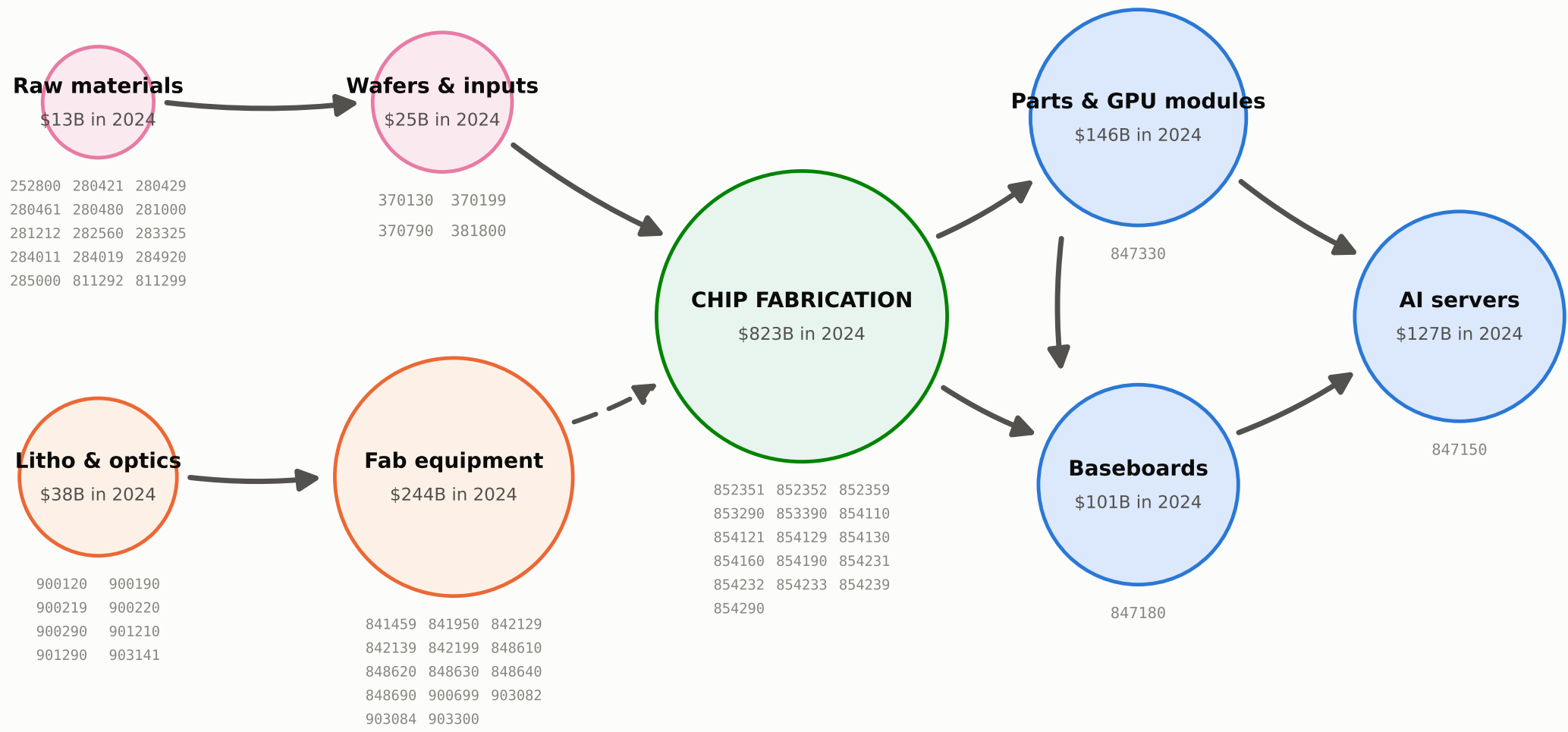


The AI-compute supply chain — stylized shape, with the HS6 codes in each node



The chain has two input branches and one output line. Materials (pink) -- silicon, chemicals, wafers -- are used up with every chip made, so those flows move together with chip output (solid arrows). Equipment (orange) -- lithography and other fab tools -- is investment in future capacity: in Taiwan and Korea, equipment imports rise six to twelve months before chip exports do (dashed arrow). Korean memory chips meet the processors at the packaging step, mostly inside Taiwan, so that step never appears in trade data; chip design earns money as a service and crosses no border at all. Circle diameters grow with the log of 2024 world trade, keeping big and small stages comparable. Blue marks the three codes of our monthly panel (the Fed's AI-compute basket). A few niche inputs -- lasers, vacuum pumps and valves, chip substrates -- fall outside the 60 codes. Code lists: OECD semiconductor mapping plus the Fed basket (docs/data.md, section 1).